ENGLISH C1 · ADVANCED GRAMMAR

Advanced verb complementation

Control complex verb patterns involving objects, infinitives, gerunds, bare infinitives and content clauses. The lesson connects form, meaning, register and real editorial decisions rather than treating the pattern as an isolated rule.

THE CENTRAL IDEA

Use advanced verb complementation to select the complement licensed by the verb and preserve who performs the embedded action while preserving the intended meaning and register.

Control complex verb patterns involving objects, infinitives, gerunds, bare infinitives and content clauses.

MODEL

The evidence led investigators to reconsider the timeline.

matrix verb + licensed complement pattern

6 GUIDED STAGES · 30 LEARNING DECISIONS

This complete guide combines explanation, visual reasoning, practice and feedback. Separate exercise and answer-key editions are also available from the lesson page.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

OUTCOME 1

01

Recognise the main advanced verb complementation patterns in authentic contexts.

OUTCOME 2

02

Choose a form that accurately expresses select the complement licensed by the verb and preserve who performs the embedded action.

OUTCOME 3

03

Avoid errors that change time, agency, emphasis or speaker commitment.

OUTCOME 4

04

Use the structure appropriately in formal writing, professional communication and precise narrative.

Build meaning before form

Control complex verb patterns involving objects, infinitives, gerunds, bare infinitives and content clauses.

What advanced verb complementation communicates

Control complex verb patterns involving objects, infinitives, gerunds, bare infinitives and content clauses.

The central purpose is to select the complement licensed by the verb and preserve who performs the embedded action. A successful choice therefore preserves the proposition while making the intended relationship, viewpoint or degree of commitment visible to the reader.

The evidence led investigators to reconsider the timeline.	causation or influence directed at an embedded subject
We appreciated their responding so quickly.	an action treated as the object of evaluation
The chair had the secretary circulate the revised agenda.	causing or arranging for a person to act

How the pattern is built

Use this working formula: matrix verb + licensed complement pattern. The formula is a decision path: it identifies the trigger, the clause architecture and the element that carries tense or modality.

The model “The evidence led investigators to reconsider the timeline.” shows the complete pattern in context. Rebuild the sentence from meaning to form instead of translating each word independently.

Choice	Structure	Example
Object to-infinitive	verb + object + to-infinitive	The evidence led investigators to reconsider the timeline.
Gerund complement	verb + possessive/object + -ing	We appreciated their responding so quickly.
Bare infinitive	let/make/have + object + base verb	The chair had the secretary circulate the revised agenda.

Choose by meaning, not by surface similarity

Neighbouring structures may contain similar words but perform different jobs. Compare the three reference patterns and name the intended effect before completing the sentence.

A reliable answer explains both why the chosen form works and why a plausible alternative would change the meaning, time relation, information focus or level of certainty.

Meaning	Best route
causation or influence directed at an embedded subject	Object to-infinitive
an action treated as the object of evaluation	Gerund complement
causing or arranging for a person to act	Bare infinitive

Register, discourse and editorial control

This grammar is especially useful in formal writing, professional communication and precise narrative. Its value comes from helping the reader process a relationship efficiently, not from making the sentence sound artificially complex.

After editing, check recoverability, natural word order and consistency with the surrounding paragraph. If the marked structure creates ambiguity, return to a fuller or more neutral clause.

Reason through the pattern

The visual map moves from communicative purpose to structural trigger, then to the final clause. It keeps meaning and form visible at the same time so the learner can justify every choice.

01	02
matrix verb	licensed complement pattern

DECIDE IN THIS ORDER

STEP 1

Decision 1

Identify the communicative purpose before selecting a form: select the complement licensed by the verb and preserve who performs the embedded action.

STEP 2

Decision 2

Locate the structural trigger and match it to one of the reference patterns.

STEP 3

Decision 3

Check time reference, clause relationships, agency and speaker commitment.

STEP 4

Decision 4

Read the complete sentence in context and confirm that its register suits formal writing, professional communication and precise narrative.

STEP 5

Decision 5

Compare the result with a neutral alternative and keep the marked form only when it adds useful meaning.

Compare forms and meanings

Use the table to justify each structural choice.

Pattern	Form	Model
Object to-infinitive	verb + object + to-infinitive	The evidence led investigators to reconsider the timeline.
Gerund complement	verb + possessive/object + -ing	We appreciated their responding so quickly.
Bare infinitive	let/make/have + object + base verb	The chair had the secretary circulate the revised agenda.

EXAMPLES AT A GLANCE

The evidence led investigators to reconsider the timeline.	causation or influence directed at an embedded subject
We appreciated their responding so quickly.	an action treated as the object of evaluation
The chair had the secretary circulate the revised agenda.	causing or arranging for a person to act

COMMON ERRORS

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not omit the object when it is the understood subject of the infinitive.

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not assume every verb accepts both gerund and infinitive without a meaning change.

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not add to after have or make in an active causative pattern.

Recognition in context

Choose the sentence whose grammar matches the stated communicative purpose.

A1 · MEANING DECISION 1

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: causation or influence directed at an embedded subject?

OPTIONS The evidence led investigators to reconsider the timeline. · We appreciated their responding so quickly. · The chair had the secretary circulate the revised agenda.

A2 · MEANING DECISION 2

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: an action treated as the object of evaluation?

OPTIONS We appreciated their responding so quickly. · The chair had the secretary circulate the revised agenda. · The evidence led investigators to reconsider the timeline.

A3 · MEANING DECISION 3

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: causing or arranging for a person to act?

OPTIONS The chair had the secretary circulate the revised agenda. · The evidence led investigators to reconsider the timeline. · We appreciated their responding so quickly.

A4 · INTERPRETATION 4

What does “The evidence led investigators to reconsider the timeline.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS causation or influence directed at an embedded subject · an action treated as the object of evaluation · causing or arranging for a person to act

A5 · INTERPRETATION 5

What does “We appreciated their responding so quickly.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS an action treated as the object of evaluation · causing or arranging for a person to act · causation or influence directed at an embedded subject

A6 · INTERPRETATION 6

What does “The chair had the secretary circulate the revised agenda.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS causing or arranging for a person to act · causation or influence directed at an embedded subject · an action treated as the object of evaluation

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Form and function

Identify both the structural family and the meaning carried by each model.

B1 · FORM AND FUNCTION 1

“The evidence led investigators to reconsider the timeline.” uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Object to-infinitive / Gerund complement / Bare infinitive · Gap 2: causation or influence directed at an embedded subject / an action treated as the object of evaluation / causing or arranging for a person to act

B2 · FORM AND FUNCTION 2

“We appreciated their responding so quickly.” uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Gerund complement / Bare infinitive / Object to-infinitive · Gap 2: an action treated as the object of evaluation / causing or arranging for a person to act / causation or influence directed at an embedded subject

B3 · FORM AND FUNCTION 3

“The chair had the secretary circulate the revised agenda.” uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Bare infinitive / Object to-infinitive / Gerund complement · Gap 2: causing or arranging for a person to act / causation or influence directed at an embedded subject / an action treated as the object of evaluation

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Guided discourse choices

Maintain accurate form and meaning across a connected sequence of decisions.

C1 · EDITORIAL PLANNING

Choose the model that expresses causation or influence directed at an embedded subject: _____. Choose the model that expresses an action treated as the object of evaluation: _____. Choose the model that expresses causing or arranging for a person to act: _____. Choose the model built with verb + object + to-infinitive: _____. Choose the model built with verb + possessive/object + -ing: _____. Choose the model built with let/make/have + object + base verb: _____.

_____
_____

WORD BANK

Available forms

The chair had the secretary circulate the revised agenda. · The evidence led investigators to reconsider the timeline. · We appreciated their responding so quickly.

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Open reconstruction

Recover the missing structural trigger without a word bank.

D1 · INDEPENDENT RECONSTRUCTION

The evidence _____ the timeline. We appreciated _____ so quickly. The chair _____ the revised agenda. State the full structural pattern for Object to-infinitive: _____. State the full structural pattern for Gerund complement: _____.

_____
_____
_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Controlled transformation

Rewrite the neutral source so that it performs the requested advanced function.

E1 · TRANSFORMATION 1

Rewrite “Because of the evidence, investigators reconsidered the timeline.” using the Object to-infinitive pattern to express causation or influence directed at an embedded subject.

_____
_____

E2 · TRANSFORMATION 2

Rewrite “We appreciated the fact that they responded quickly.” using the Gerund complement pattern to express an action treated as the object of evaluation.

_____
_____

E3 · TRANSFORMATION 3

Rewrite “The chair arranged for the secretary to circulate the agenda.” using the Bare infinitive pattern to express causing or arranging for a person to act.

_____
_____

E4 · TRANSFORMATION 4

Rewrite “Because of the evidence, investigators reconsidered the timeline.” using the Object to-infinitive pattern to express causation or influence directed at an embedded subject.

_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Communicative production

Use the grammar independently in realistic academic, professional and conversational contexts.

F1 · PRODUCTION TASK 1

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Object to-infinitive to express causation or influence directed at an embedded subject, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

F2 · PRODUCTION TASK 2

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Gerund complement to express an action treated as the object of evaluation, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

F3 · PRODUCTION TASK 3

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Bare infinitive to express causing or arranging for a person to act, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

Final self-check

Complete these prompts without reopening the guide.

R1 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: communicative purpose.

_____
_____
_____

R2 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: structural trigger.

_____
_____
_____

R3 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: meaning contrast.

_____
_____
_____

R4 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: register choice.

_____
_____
_____

Recognition in context

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

A1

The evidence led investigators to reconsider the timeline.

Object to-infinitive is the best match because causation or influence directed at an embedded subject.

A2

We appreciated their responding so quickly.

Gerund complement is the best match because an action treated as the object of evaluation.

A3

The chair had the secretary circulate the revised agenda.

Bare infinitive is the best match because causing or arranging for a person to act.

A4

causation or influence directed at an embedded subject

The Object to-infinitive pattern communicates causation or influence directed at an embedded subject.

A5

an action treated as the object of evaluation

The Gerund complement pattern communicates an action treated as the object of evaluation.

A6

causing or arranging for a person to act

The Bare infinitive pattern communicates causing or arranging for a person to act.

Form and function

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

B1

Object to-infinitive / causation or influence directed at an embedded subject

The structure belongs to the Object to-infinitive pattern. Its communicative purpose is causation or influence directed at an embedded subject.

B2

Gerund complement / an action treated as the object of evaluation

The structure belongs to the Gerund complement pattern. Its communicative purpose is an action treated as the object of evaluation.

B3

Bare infinitive / causing or arranging for a person to act

The structure belongs to the Bare infinitive pattern. Its communicative purpose is causing or arranging for a person to act.

Guided discourse choices

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

C1

The evidence led investigators to reconsider the timeline.

Object to-infinitive: verb + object + to-infinitive.

C2

We appreciated their responding so quickly.

Gerund complement: verb + possessive/object + -ing.

C3

The chair had the secretary circulate the revised agenda.

Bare infinitive: let/make/have + object + base verb.

C4

The evidence led investigators to reconsider the timeline.

Object to-infinitive: verb + object + to-infinitive.

C5

We appreciated their responding so quickly.

Gerund complement: verb + possessive/object + -ing.

C6

The chair had the secretary circulate the revised agenda.

Bare infinitive: let/make/have + object + base verb.

Open reconstruction

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

D1

led investigators to reconsider

Object to-infinitive requires “led investigators to reconsider” in this model. verb + object + to-infinitive.

D2

their responding

Gerund complement requires “their responding” in this model. verb + possessive/object + -ing.

D3

had the secretary circulate

Bare infinitive requires “had the secretary circulate” in this model. let/make/have + object + base verb.

D4

verb + object + to-infinitive

Object to-infinitive is built as verb + object + to-infinitive.

D5

verb + possessive/object + -ing

Gerund complement is built as verb + possessive/object + -ing.

Controlled transformation

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

E1

The evidence led investigators to reconsider the timeline.

verb + object + to-infinitive. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended object to-infinitive effect.

E2

We appreciated their responding so quickly.

verb + possessive/object + -ing. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended gerund complement effect.

E3

The chair had the secretary circulate the revised agenda.

let/make/have + object + base verb. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended bare infinitive effect.

E4

The evidence led investigators to reconsider the timeline.

verb + object + to-infinitive. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended object to-infinitive effect.

Communicative production

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

F1

The evidence led investigators to reconsider the timeline. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses verb + object + to-infinitive accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

F2

We appreciated their responding so quickly. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses verb + possessive/object + -ing accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

F3

The chair had the secretary circulate the revised agenda. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses let/make/have + object + base verb accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

Diagnose the pattern, not only the score

Use this page to decide what to revisit in the complete guide.

CHECK · TRIGGER OR CONTEXT

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · AUXILIARY OR STRUCTURAL CHOICE

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · MAIN VERB OR CLAUSE FORM

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · MEANING AND REGISTER

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____